

NICOLAS S. DENNA

Strategic Commercial Director — Luxury Fashion & High-End Textile

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Native Italian & French · Fluent English · Intermediate German · Basic Japanese

EXECUTIVE PROFILE

Commercial leader with 15+ years driving growth across luxury fashion and high-end textile in Europe and Asia — including six years as Commercial Director of **External Activities** at **Hermès Textile Division**, on the Business Unit Executive Committee. Proven builder of commercial functions, elite sales teams and premium client portfolios; equally strong on P&L rigor, margin and the creative-commercial bridge. Now completing a Global MBA in AI & Entrepreneurship (Tel Aviv University), bringing a rare fusion of luxury operational excellence and next-generation technology. Above all, a lifelong passion for textile — its complexity, its materials and its makers — drives everything I do. Philosophy: *keep the know-how, make it shine*.

CAREER HIGHLIGHTS

- **Hermès pedigree** — six years as Commercial Director, External Activities, on the Business Unit Executive Committee of Hermès Textile Division.
- **Scale & growth** — ran a ~€30M commercial P&L across four Asian offices; grew turnover **+40%** at Bonotto.
- **Luxury × technology** — founded a phygital B2B platform with a **3D digital-twin showroom** — 27 Italian brands, ~50 agents, **3.4× average order value**.
- **Strategic builder** — created new business lines from scratch and re-engineered client portfolios toward a premium core (**300** → **20** accounts), consistently lifting service and margin.

Leadership: a visionary, high-standards leader and a natural bridge between creative and commercial — known for energizing teams with fresh, out-of-the-box thinking.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Leadership: P&L Management · Multi-Market Commercial Strategy · Organizational Transformation · Executive Committee & Stakeholder Management

Operations: Multi-Site Industrial Forecasting · Supply Chain & Output Planning · Financial Reporting & Controls · Product-to-Market Speed

Commercial: B2B Sales Leadership · Key Account Management · Premiumization · Asian Market Entry · CRM & Digital Sales

Innovation: AI & Entrepreneurship (MBA) · Creative-Commercial Alignment · Fashion-Tech · Market Diversification

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Founder | Brand Selection

International · 2024 – Present

Early-stage B2B platform helping Made-in-Italy fashion SMEs scale internationally in the phygital era.

- Signed **27 Italian SME brands** and built a network of **~50 agents** across Italy, the EU and beyond onto a B2B marketplace.
- Designed and built a **phygital sales process**, including a **digital-twin 3D gallery** enabling a hybrid physical-plus-digital purchase journey.
- Lifted average order value from **€250 to €850 (3.4×)**, with marketplace conversion of **~30%** versus a ~2.5% industry benchmark.
- Self-taught coding and earned multiple **AI certifications** (sales automation, AI-assisted presentations), applied directly to commercial workflows.

Commercial Director — External Activities | Hermès Textile Division (HTH)

Pierre-Bénite, France · 2019 – 2025

Owned the P&L for External Activities — external commercialization of the output of 8 Hermès-owned textile factories (finished accessories, fabric, semi-finished), a high-margin business, as a member of the Business Unit Executive Committee.

- Launched a new fashion textile accessories department, scaling revenue from **€100K to €2M (20×)**.
- Redesigned the client model, concentrating accounts from **~300 to 20** — lifting service levels and margin while reducing complexity.
- Led a **~13-person commercial organization** (4 sales directors, US & Paris offices, Customer Service, Sampling) plus a worldwide agent network.
- Cross-skilled the team into hybrid commercial-technical roles and opened structured collaboration with the Design department.
- Cut cost base (tradeshows, sampling) while protecting margin; delivered rigorous financial reporting and industrial forecasting across all 8 sites.

Director of Sales & Management, Asia | Zegna Baruffa Lane Borgosesia

Biella, Italy · 2018 – 2019

High-end knitting yarns for luxury fashion brands. Reported directly to the CEO.

- Led a **~€30M** Asian business across 4 offices (China, Japan and beyond) with a team of 10+.
- Consolidated market share and diversified the client portfolio in highly competitive markets.
- Introduced CRM and digital sales strategies tailored to high-end Asian luxury segments.

Sales Manager — France, Scandinavia, Benelux & Australia | Bonotto (Ermenegildo Zegna Group)

Vicenza, Italy · 2015 – 2018

Creative textile manufacturer supplying top luxury brands.

- Grew turnover by **40%** across four markets.
- Deep expertise in exclusive fabric development (Jacquards, Rachels, shuttle & hand looms, bonding, specialist finishing) and designer/buyer relationships.

Business Development Worldwide & Europe Sales Manager | Canclini Group

Como, Italy · 2013 – 2015

- Built European B2B distribution for the Profilo Tessile brand; developed Far-East mill partnerships (Thailand, Vietnam).

Country Manager, India | Opto-Engineering

Pune, India · 2010 – 2013

- Founded the Indian representative office; scaled business development for industrial AI-vision systems.

Co-Founder | General-Oxo

Chiasso, Switzerland · 2007 – 2010

- Co-founded a commodity-trading startup specializing in bulk petrochemicals.

EDUCATION

Sofaer Global MBA — AI & Entrepreneurship · Tel Aviv University, Coller School of Management · 2025 – 2026

BSc, Business Administration · Carlo Cattaneo University (LIUC), Italy · 2002 – 2007

International exchanges: Chinese University of Hong Kong · Hosei University, Tokyo (Japanese Govt. Scholarship) · Lehigh University, PA, USA (Iacocca Foundation).

Executive education: Hermès Campus (Management & Leadership) · Pambianco E-Academy (Chinese Luxury Market).

LANGUAGES & SKILLS

Languages: Italian & French (native) · English (fluent) · German (intermediate) · Japanese (basic)

Tech & Tools: CRM · SAP / Industrial ERPs · Data Analysis · AI & Digital Fashion Tools